SALES LESSON PLAN 04 / SOURCE MATERIAL

Discovery Calls

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Level: B1
Duration: 60 minutes
Topic: Vocabulary for Discovery Calls
Main objective: By the end of the lesson, the student will be able to understand and use common vocabulary and expressions for conducting a discovery call, asking questions, qualifying a potential customer, understanding their situation, and agreeing on next steps.

1. Lead-in - What Is a Discovery Call?

5-10 minutes

Start by asking the student what they think a discovery call is.

The teacher asks:

What is a discovery call?

Who usually participates in a discovery call?

Why does a salesperson have a discovery call with a potential customer?

What questions should a salesperson ask?

Should you talk about your product immediately?

What information do you need before recommending a solution?

What makes a discovery call successful?

Quick brainstorm

Write:

DISCOVERY CALL

Then ask the student to brainstorm vocabulary connected with:

Customer

Problem

Business

Budget

Goals

Decision

Timeline

Solution

Then, show the student the following picture to make connections and describe the different types of customers and decisions each person is taking:

2. Warm-up activity-What Would You Ask?

5 minutes

Give the student three situations.

Situation A - New CRM

"We're a growing company, but our sales team is still using spreadsheets to manage customer information."

Ask:

What questions would you ask this customer?

Situation B - Communication Problem

"Our sales and customer service teams don't communicate well."

Ask:

What would you like to know before offering a solution?

Situation C - Software Upgrade

"We're thinking about changing our current software."

Ask:

What information would you need to understand before recommending your product?

The purpose is to move the student from simply identifying a problem to thinking about the questions needed to understand the situation.

3. Vocabulary Presentation - Discovery Calls

15 minutes

A. People & Sales Process

Vocabulary

Meaning

prospect

a potential customer

lead

a person or company that may become a customer

decision-maker

the person who makes the final decision

stakeholder

a person involved or affected by the decision

sales representative

the person selling the product/service

discovery call

a call to understand a potential customer's situation and needs

qualify a lead

decide if a potential customer is a good fit

Examples

We have a new prospect interested in our software.

Who is the decision-maker?

I'd like to use this call to qualify the lead.

B. Understanding the Customer's Situation

Vocabulary

Meaning

current situation

what is happening now

current solution

the product/system the customer currently uses

challenge

a difficult situation

pain point

an important problem for the customer

business need

something the company needs

requirement

something the customer specifically needs

goal

something the customer wants to achieve

Useful expressions

Could you tell me about your current situation?

What solution are you currently using?

What are your biggest challenges?

What are your main business needs?

C. Qualification Vocabulary

Vocabulary

Meaning

budget

the amount of money available

timeline

the period of time for a project

priority

something that is especially important

decision process

how a company makes a decision

buying process

the steps involved in buying something

fit

how suitable something is for a customer

available

ready or possible to use

Examples

Do you have a budget for this project?

What's your timeline?

Is this a high priority for your company?

Could you tell me about your decision process?

I'd like to understand if our solution is a good fit for your business.

D. Discovery Call Verbs

Verb	Example
identify	identify a problem
understand	understand a need
explore	explore a challenge
uncover	uncover a pain point
clarify	clarify a requirement
qualify	qualify a lead
assess	assess the situation
determine	determine the customer's needs
recommend	recommend a solution

4. Vocabulary Practice - Match the Words

10 minutes

A. Match the vocabulary with its definition.

prospect

decision-maker

stakeholder

budget

timeline

current solution

qualify

fit

pain point

requirement

a. ___ something the customer specifically needs

b. ___ the amount of money available for a project

c. ___ a potential customer

d. ___ how suitable a product or service is for a customer

e. ___ the person who makes the final decision

f. ___ an important problem for the customer

g. ___ a person involved in or affected by a business decision

h. ___ the product or system the customer uses now

i. ___ decide whether a lead is a good potential customer

j. ___ the period of time for a project

B. Complete the sentences

Use:

prospect - decision-maker - budget - timeline - current solution - fit - pain point - qualify

We have a new _____ who is interested in our software.

Who is the _____ for this project?

What is your _____ for the new system?

Could you tell me about your _____?

What is your _____ for implementing the new solution?

What is the biggest _____ you are trying to solve?

We need to _____ this lead before moving forward.

Let's see if our product is a good _____ for your business.

5. Reading - A Discovery Call

15 minutes

Understanding the Prospect

Emma is a Sales Executive at TechSolutions. She is having a discovery call with Michael, the Operations Director of a growing logistics company.

Emma: Hi Michael, thanks for taking the time to speak with me today.

Michael: You're welcome. We're interested in learning more about your software.

Emma: Great. Before I tell you about the product, I'd like to understand your current situation. Could you tell me a little about how you're managing your operations at the moment?

Michael: We're currently using two different systems. They're not well connected, and our employees have to enter the same information more than once.

Emma: I see. What would you say is your biggest pain point?

Michael: Definitely the amount of time we spend entering and checking information.

Emma: And what impact does that have on your business?

Michael: It slows our teams down and sometimes creates errors.

Emma: That makes sense. What are your main goals for a new solution?

Michael: We'd like to save time, reduce errors, and improve communication between our teams.

Emma: What are your main requirements?

Michael: The system needs to be easy to use and integrate with our existing software.

Emma: That's helpful. Do you already have a budget for this project?

Michael: Yes, but we need to stay within a specific budget.

Emma: Understood. And what is your timeline?

Michael: Ideally, we'd like to have a new system in place within three months.

Emma: Okay. And could you tell me a little about your decision process? Who else is involved?

Michael: Our IT Manager and Finance Director will also be involved. I'm responsible for evaluating the different options, but the final decision will be made by our CEO.

Emma: That's very helpful. So, if I understand correctly, your main goals are to save time, reduce errors, and improve communication. You need a solution that is easy to use, works with your existing software, and fits your budget and timeline.

Michael: Exactly.

Emma: Great. Based on what you've told me, I think our solution could be a good fit. Would it make sense to schedule a product demonstration next week?

Michael: Yes, that sounds good.

6. Reading Comprehension

A. Answer the questions.

What does Michael's company currently use?

What is their biggest pain point?

What problems does the current situation cause?

What are Michael's three main goals?

What are two requirements for the new solution?

Does the company already have a budget?

What is their timeline?

Who will be involved in the decision?

Who makes the final decision?

What does Emma suggest as the next step?

B. Vocabulary in Context

Find expressions in the dialogue that mean:

Ask about the customer's current situation.

> _____

Ask about the customer's biggest problem.

> _____

Ask about the customer's goals.

> _____

Ask about the customer's requirements.

> _____

Ask about money.

> _____

Ask about time.

> _____

Ask who participates in the decision.

> _____

Check that you understand the customer.

> _____

Say that your product may be suitable.

> _____

Suggest a next step.

> _____

7. Speaking

10-15 minutes

Speaking to a new prospect

Imagine you are speaking to a new prospect and need to discover the following information:

Information

What do you need to ask?

Current situation

Main problem

Pain point

Goals

Requirements

Budget

Timeline

Decision-maker

Other stakeholders

Next steps

Say one question for each category.

B. Discovery Call Role-play

Situation

You are a Sales Representative for a technology company.

Your company sells a software platform that helps businesses manage customers, sales, and internal communication.

Your teacher is a potential customer.

Your objective:

You need to conduct a discovery call.

Do NOT present the product immediately.

First, understand the customer.

You must find out:

What system they currently use

Their biggest problem

Their main pain point

Their business goals

Their requirements

Their budget

Their timeline

Who makes the decision

Who else is involved

What the next step should be

Useful language

Opening

Thanks for taking the time to speak with me.

I'd like to understand your current situation.

Exploring

Could you tell me a little more about...?

How are you currently...?

What challenges are you facing?

What is your biggest pain point?

Goals

What are you hoping to achieve?

What would you like to improve?

What are your main priorities?

Qualification

Do you already have a budget?

What's your timeline?

Who is involved in the decision?

Who is the final decision-maker?

Clarifying

Could you tell me more about that?

What do you mean by...?

Could you give me an example?

Summarizing

So, if I understand correctly...

Your main priorities are...

It sounds like your biggest challenge is...

Next steps

Based on what you've told me...

I think we may be able to help.

Would it make sense to schedule a demonstration?

Shall we arrange another call?

7. Wrap-up & Feedback

5 minutes

The teacher gives feedback on:

Grammar accuracy

Vocabulary

Pronunciation

Fluency

Professional register

Visual resources from the original lesson plan







